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JOANNE LITTLE IN CHICAGO: "SUPPORT DELBERT TIBBS"

(Chicago, Ill.) - JoAnne Little made a three day whirlwind trip through Chicago from September 18 through the 21, to help focus attention on the Delbert Tibbs case.

Returning to Chicago for the first time since her historic acquittal in North Carolina — of charges stemming from an incident in which she defended herself against a racist prison guard who attempted to rape her — JoAnne was featured on radio and TV shows throughout her stay here. With a few notable exceptions, the press showed her great respect and she was able to bring the Delbert Tibbs case to the attention of hundreds of thousands of people in Chicago.

Delbert Tibbs is a 36-year-old Black man from Chicago charged with rape in Florida. This tragic but all too familiar case brought Tibbs before an all White jury which convicted him of raping a White woman. The Delbert Tibbs Defense Committee points out that the evidence was almost non-existent.

The woman's contradictory story and consistent errors about the description of the so-called "rapist" was corroborated only by the testimony of a convicted and self-confessed rapist who claimed Tibbs confessed the crime to him while in jail. The date the man gave for this so-called confession, however, was three weeks prior to the time when he met Tibbs in jail.

A writer, Tibbs was traveling through the country, alone, with very little money, hoping

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Sister JoANNE LITTLE came to Chicago on a whirlwind, 3-day campaign to rally support for Delbert Tibbs, a 36-year-old Black man falsely accused of raping a White woman in Florida. JoAnne is beaming as she receives a bouquet of flowers from a young White supporter at a Community Forum sponsored by the Intercommunal Survival Committee.

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